

Bootstrap vs Normal CSS (Plain CSS)

1. What is Normal CSS?

CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) is the core language used to style web pages.

With normal CSS, you:

- Write styles **from scratch**
- Control layout, colors, spacing, fonts, animations, etc.
- Decide how everything looks and behaves on different screen sizes

Example (Normal CSS):

```
.button {  
  background-color: blue;  
  color: white;  
  padding: 10px 16px;  
  border-radius: 6px;  
}
```

Pros

- Full control and flexibility
- Lightweight (only what you write is loaded)
- Best for custom designs

Cons

- Takes more time
- You must handle responsiveness yourself
- Repetitive code for common UI elements

2. What is Bootstrap?

Bootstrap is a **CSS framework**—a collection of **pre-written CSS and JavaScript** that helps you build responsive websites faster.

It provides:

- Pre-designed components (buttons, navbars, cards, modals)
- A responsive grid system
- Utility classes for spacing, colors, display, flexbox
- Built-in responsiveness (mobile-first)

Example (Bootstrap):

```
<button class="btn btn-primary">Click Me</button>
```

No CSS required—Bootstrap already defines it.

Pros

- Very fast development
- Responsive by default
- Consistent design
- Great for beginners and large teams

Cons

- Websites can look similar if not customized
- Extra CSS/JS even if you don't use everything
- Less design freedom unless you override styles

3. Key Differences (Quick Comparison)

Feature	Normal CSS	Bootstrap
Setup	No library needed	Requires Bootstrap files
Speed	Slower	Faster
Customization	Full control	Limited unless customized
Responsiveness	Manual	Built-in
Learning Curve	Medium	Easy
File Size	Small	Larger

4. When to Use Each?

Use Normal CSS when:

- You want a unique design
- Performance is critical
- You're building a custom UI system

Use Bootstrap when:

- You need fast development
- You're building admin panels, dashboards, or prototypes
- You want responsive design with minimal effort

5. Best Practice (Professional Tip)

Many developers **combine both**:

- Use **Bootstrap** for layout and common components
- Use **custom CSS** for branding and fine-tuning

👉 Bootstrap **does not replace CSS**—it is **built on top of CSS**.

Instructor

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